

What is Java used for?

Java is used in many systems that people use today, including microblogging social media sites, film-streaming sites, and lots of Android phone apps. Many large banks and airlines use Java to code their systems as it enables them to create and subsequently enlarge systems that carry out large numbers of database operations. Java is possibly the world's most popular programming language.

▷ Who can use it?

Java is very powerful and opens up many possibilities, but it could be confusing for a new coder who may be better off learning Scratch or Python to begin with.

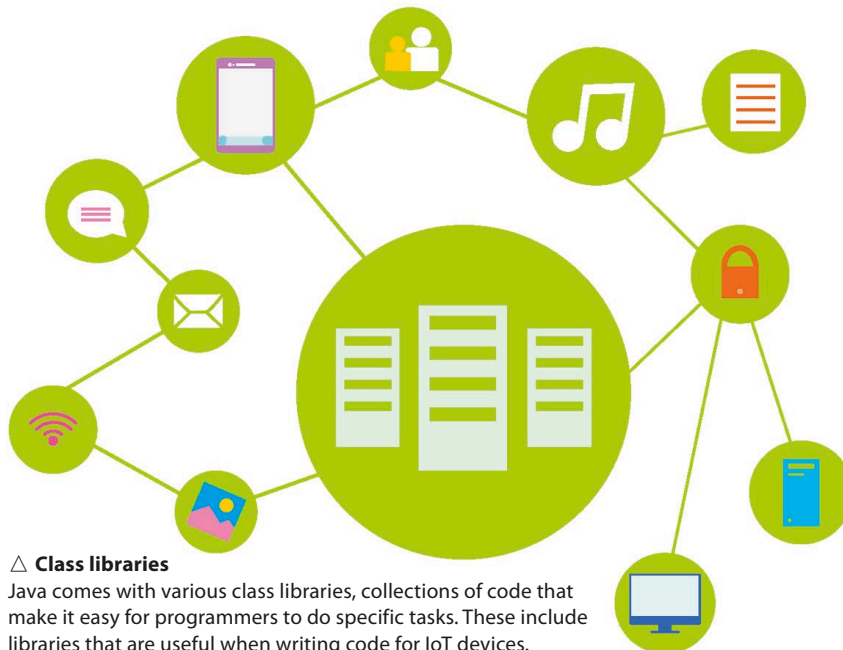
This code prints a
countdown from 10 to 0.

```
public class Countdown {  
    public static void main(String[] args) {  
        int count = 10;  
        while(count > 0){  
            System.out.println(count + "\n");  
            count--;  
        }  
        System.out.print("LIFT OFF! \n");  
    }  
}
```

When the count
reaches 0, "LIFT OFF!"
is printed.

Internet of Things

The Internet of Things (IoT) is the name for the increasing network of objects in the physical world able to connect to the internet. These can include smart appliances such as refrigerators, sensors on farm animals to monitor their health, or thermostats in forests to detect fires. Java has many advantages when it comes to programming these devices, as there is already a version of Java designed for programming small embedded and mobile systems.



△ Class libraries

Java comes with various class libraries, collections of code that make it easy for programmers to do specific tasks. These include libraries that are useful when writing code for IoT devices. Programmers using Java have also created libraries for specific devices, many of which are available for other coders to use.

REAL WORLD

Minecraft

The original version of the popular game Minecraft was written in Java. Users were able to write "mods" (short for "modifications") that changed the behaviour of the game world. This was done either by editing the Java source code of the game, or uploading their own Java code. Microsoft recently bought the game and is moving towards a version in C++, but is currently still supporting the Java version.

